

ACTIVITY 17 — FACILITATOR GUIDE**Conflict Resolution: Five Modes, Leas' Levels and Negotiation**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Role Play	90 minutes	LO3	4 - Lead the Project Team

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to place each of the five conflict-handling modes on the assertiveness/cooperativeness axes and state the legitimate use of each.

What learners produce

conflict log, roleplay notes, resolution plan — submitted to artifacts/.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- Laptop with internet access for the live problem-solving tools
- The course slides for the framework and worked example

Set-up

Groups of 3 so every role is played. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Learning Pte Ltd is a training provider with 14,000 active learners. Its course registration portal is 9 years old. Registration takes a median of 11 minutes and 34% of attempts are abandoned. Learner communications consume 24 staff-hours per week across 3 administrators. 62% of learner traffic is mobile, against a portal that is not responsive. Legacy consent screens do not meet current PDPA requirements. The project modernises course registration and learner communications.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Build the conflict log. Create artifacts/17-conflict-log.md. Log conflict as you log risk: recording it is what stops it escalating unnoticed from L2 to L3.	Keep role-holders in role; learners drift to consensus. Push for the concern behind the stated position.
2	Role-play 1: two developers on architecture (L1/L2). Create artifacts/17-roleplay-notes.md. Work in pairs. Read only your own role card. Ten minutes of role-play, five minutes of debrief.	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.
3	Role-play 2: Head of Sales versus product owner on scope (L3)	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.
4	Role-play 3: QA lead versus dev lead on the definition of done (L2/L3)	Keep role-holders in role; learners drift to consensus. Push for the concern behind the stated position.

5	Role-play 4: admin staff versus Ops Manager on redundancy (escalating, high emotion)	If the room agrees too quickly, take the quietest role aside and give them one more constraint.
6	Build the resolution plan. Create artifacts/17-resolution-plan.md. Every open conflict in the log gets a level, a target level, a mode, an action, an owner, a date and an escalation trigger.	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.
7	Negotiation: positions, interests, BATNA and ZOPA. Worked example on the real Contoso negotiation, CF-06:	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
8	Answer the exam-style scenarios	If the room agrees too quickly, take the quietest role aside and give them one more constraint.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
9 min	Brief the scenario, confirm the inputs and assign roles
33 min	Work the first half of the steps individually, then pool as a group
34 min	Complete the remaining steps and finalise the deliverable
14 min	Group share-back, facilitator debrief and exam-style linkage

Total: 90 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Place each of the five conflict-handling modes on the assertiveness/cooperativeness axes and state the legitimate use of each — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
2. Explain why collaborate is the usual keyed answer and identify the specific cases where it is the wrong one — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
3. Diagnose conflict intensity on Leas' five levels from the language people use — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
4. Every one of the five modes has a legitimate use written against it. If your notes say force and withdraw are always wrong, you will get the safety question wrong — can every member of your group defend it?
5. Where would conflict resolution: five modes, leas' levels and negotiation have saved you time or money on a real project you have worked on?

What good looks like

- Every one of the five modes has a legitimate use written against it. If your notes say force and withdraw are always wrong, you will get the safety question wrong.
- You can name three situations in which collaborate is NOT the right answer, and say why in each case.
- Your Leas diagnoses cite the actual words spoken, not your impression of the tone.
- You can state what changes at level 4 and why collaboration is unavailable above level 3.
- Your CF-04 entry treats the admin staff as dependent stakeholders and has the PM advocating, not chairing neutrally - and you can defend why that is not a loss of impartiality.
- Your role-play 1 debrief names the spike-first option and identifies the single question that surfaces both interests.
- Your role-play 2 notes convert "is AI important" into a concrete either/or with a number attached.

- Your role-play 3 notes reach the structural cause (no transfer point, quality treated as an end stage) and not just the two disputed stories.